ALEX CORDOBES CHEESECAKE

YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	OVEN
1 x 20 cm cake, 8 servings	**20-30 min depending on the crust**	**8 h chill**	**320F, 40 min**

ENERGY COST
$2.41 (40 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

METHOD

1. Pick a base. The Maria cookie base is faster, the shortbread crust is a real pastry and needs a 10 to 12 minute blind bake first.
2. Line a 20 cm springform with crumpled parchment standing well above the rim.
3. Press the base in and compact it.
4. Make the filling, pour it over the base.
5. Bake at 320F for 40 minutes.
6. Chill 8 hours before slicing.

NOTES

> Basque style, so a dark scorched top is the goal rather than a fault.
> Total elapsed time is dominated by the 8 hour chill, so this is a day-ahead cake.
> Filed under tarts because it is a crust plus a filling, which is the same structure, even though it is a cake by name.

DOUGH
Maria Cookie Base

Yield: base for 1 x 20 cm cake / Active Time: 10 min

INGREDIENTS

200 g	Maria cookies
80 g	Butter, melted

METHOD

1. Crush the cookies to fine crumbs in a processor, or in a sealed bag with a rolling pin.
2. Mix with the melted butter until every crumb is damp.
3. Press firmly into the base of a lined 20 cm tin, compacting with the bottom of a glass.

NOTES

> No bake needed before filling, unlike the shortbread crust alternative.
> Two ingredients, so it is the fast route.

DOUGH
Cheesecake Shortbread Crust

Yield: 1 x 20 cm base, 4-5 mm thick / Active Time: 15 min / Oven: 320F for 10-12 min, blind / Energy Cost: $1.45 (12 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

150 g	All-purpose flour
75 g	Cold butter, cubed
30 g	Sugar
a pinch	Salt

METHOD

1. Combine flour, sugar and salt, then add the cold cubed butter.
2. Rub in with your fingertips to coarse sand with some pea-sized butter left. Work fast to keep it cold.
3. Press firmly and evenly into the lined tin, about 4 to 5 mm thick, compacting with a glass.
4. Blind bake 10 to 12 minutes at 320F until lightly golden at the edges.
5. Cool slightly while you make the filling.

NOTES

The alternative to the Maria cookie base, and the reason to pick it is a real pastry crust rather than a crumb one.
Unlike the cookie base, this one gets a blind bake, which is what stops it going soggy under a wet filling.
Leaving pea-sized pieces of butter in is deliberate, so stop short of a uniform powder.

FILLING

Basque Cheesecake Filling

Yield: fills 1 x 20 cm cake, 8 servings / Active Time: 20 min / Rest: 8 h chill / Oven: 320F, 40 min / Energy Cost: $2.41 (40 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

400 g	Cream cheese, Philadelphia style, room temperature
200 ml	Heavy cream, 35% fat
4 large	Eggs
150 g	Sugar
8 g	All-purpose flour
a pinch	Salt

METHOD

1. Bring the cream cheese to room temperature, at least an hour out of the fridge, or it will stay lumpy.
2. Whisk the eggs and cream smooth. Do not overbeat.
3. Add the cream cheese and bring it together with a spatula, stirring rather than whisking. Air bubbles crack the top.
4. Sift the flour over and fold until no streaks remain.
5. Fold in the sugar and salt with the spatula.
6. Pour into the prepared crust and bake at 320F for 40 minutes.
7. Chill 8 hours before cutting.

NOTES

Only 8 g of flour across the whole filling, which is what keeps it custardy rather than cakey.
Line the tin with crumpled parchment standing well above the rim, since it climbs a lot during the bake.
Stir, never whisk, once the cheese is in.
The 8 hour chill is not optional if you want clean slices.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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